



2004

Pollution peaked in 2004.
By that time many trees had died.

[At the start of 2004, many trees had already died.]



2005

Following new laws in 2005,
pollution levels dropped.

[After new laws were passed in 2005, pollution levels dropped.]



Since then, there have been
some signs of a recovery.

[From that point onward, there has been a slight recovery.]



33.9 READ THE ARTICLE AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

Humans are producing less waste now than they used to.

True ☐ False ☒ Not given ☐

- 1 Radioactive waste is the most widespread problem.
True ☐ False ☐ Not given ☐
- 2 All the waste is poured into rivers.
True ☐ False ☐ Not given ☐
- 3 The kind of waste humans produce has changed over time.
True ☐ False ☐ Not given ☐
- 4 Modern plastics can be difficult to dispose of effectively.
True ☐ False ☐ Not given ☐

28 THE ENVIRONMENT

THE PROBLEM WITH POLLUTION

Pollution levels rising across the globe.

The growing human population is producing more and more waste, ranging from sewage and smog to radioactive fuel. Dealing with all this waste is a huge problem. Much of it is just dumped, pumped into the atmosphere, or even poured into rivers and oceans. The resulting pollution is damaging nature.

One of the main issues is the kind of waste humans are now producing. Until the mid-20th century, most of the waste was buried and it just slowly decayed. Nowadays, however,

modern plastics make up a large portion of what we throw away. These plastics are almost indestructible by any natural process, so they just pile up, creating huge heaps of waste.



33 CHECKLIST

⚙️ "Should have" and "ought to have" ☐

Aa Time markers ☐

🧩 Expressing regret about the past ☐